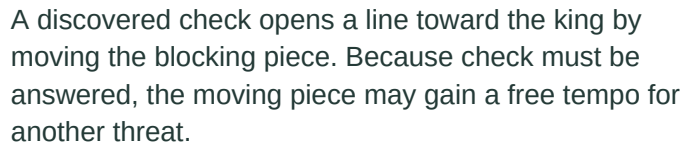


Discovered checks

WHAT THIS POSITION TEACHES



Trace the hidden checking line first. Then examine where the blocker can move to attack or capture something important.

The defending king is on g8. Geometrically undefended: knight on f1. Check for tactical protection.

WORKED CONTINUATION - COVER THIS SECTION FIRST

15.c5+ Check restricts Black to 4 legal replies here. From c5 it attacks queen on d6 and bishop on b6. Recorded reply: **15...Kh8**.

At the end, nominal material is White 27 / Black 26 (P=1, N/B=3, R=5, Q=9). Over this line, White's balance changes by +9. Activity and king safety still affect the evaluation.

Using $P=1$, $N/B=3$, $R=5$, $Q=9$, how much does White's material balance change over the complete line? **Answer:** +9: the balance goes from -8 to +1. Count promotions and every recapture, not just the first gain.

The checking line must actually be clear, and moving the blocker must not expose your own king to check.